

Data Enhancement: Principles, Resources, Wikidata

Data Enhancement

Open Research in the Digital Humanities

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What Is Data Enhancement?

Data enhancement enriches a dataset by adding missing information or correcting irregular information from an external source, making it more useful for research.

- Add identifiers, connections, or context to existing data.
- Link records to authority resources and knowledge bases.
- Record what was added, from which source, and why.
- Enhancement is an interpretive research decision.

References for further reading:

Rother, Lynn, Max Koss, and Fabio Mariani. “Taking Care of History: Toward a Politics of Provenance Linked Open Data in Museums.” In Perspectives on Data. Chicago: Art Institute of Chicago, 2022. https://www.artic.edu/digital-publications/37/perspectives-on-data/25/taking-care-of-history-toward-a-politics-of-provenance-linked-open-data-in-museums.

Principles of Responsible Enhancement

Provenance record the source of every addition.

Authority use stable identifiers where available.

Context keep records connected to their historical setting.

Uncertainty represent incomplete or disputed information as such.

Traceability preserve the original and document all changes.

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Alkemade, Henk, et al. "Datasheets for Digital Cultural Heritage Datasets." Journal of Open Humanities Data 9 (2023). https://doi.org/10.5334/johd.263.

Candela, Gustavo. "An Automatic Data Quality Approach to Assess Semantic Data from Cultural Heritage Institutions." Journal of the Association for Information Science and Technology 74, no. 7 (2023): 866–78. https://doi.org/10.1002/asi.24761.

Resources and a Workflow for Enhancement

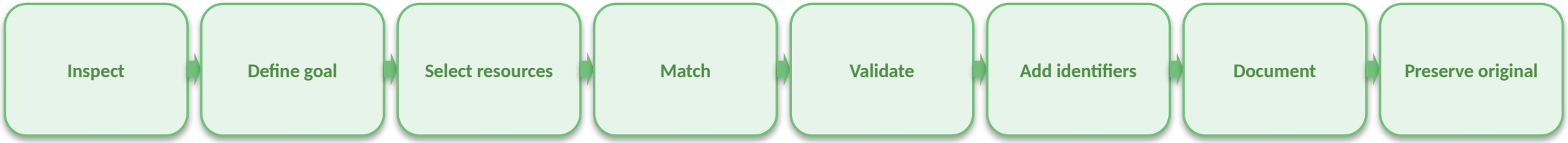
Wikidata provides:

- persistent identifiers for people, places, institutions and works
- multilingual labels and structured relationships
- links to external authority systems
- queryable and visualisable data
- a complement to institutional catalogues

Resources for enhancement:

- institutional catalogues
- library & archival authority files
- national thesauri & gazetteers
- Wikidata, VIAF, ULAN
- structured APIs

A responsible workflow:



References for further reading:

Fagerving, Alicia. “Wikidata for Authority Control: Sharing Museum Knowledge with the World.” Digital Humanities in the Nordic and Baltic Countries Publications 5, no. 1 (2023): 222–39. https://doi.org/10.5617/dhnbpub.10665.

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Candela, Gustavo, et al. “A Systematic Review of Wikidata in GLAM Institutions: A Labs Approach.” In Theory and Practice of Digital Libraries (TPDL), 2024.

Fagerving, Alicia. “Wikidata for Authority Control: Sharing Museum Knowledge with the World.” Digital Humanities in the Nordic and Baltic Countries Publications 5, no. 1 (2023): 222–39. https://doi.org/10.5617/dhnbpub.10665.

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